Consent Document

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KEY INFORMATION
Your participation in the study is voluntary, and you may choose not to participate or stop at any time without penalty. The purpose of this study is to understand how people interact with information related to alcohol and health while attempting to change their drinking behaviors. If you choose to participate, you will complete brief daily and event-based surveys on your smartphone for four weeks, participate in a 2-week check-in, and complete a remote interview at the end of the study. The risks of this study are minimal and may include mild discomfort when reflecting on alcohol use or health-related experiences. You may not receive direct benefits, but your participation may help improve understanding of the role of information in health behavior change. You will earn up to $100 for completing all study activities. Compensation will be provided based on the number of activities completed.

BACKGROUND
You are being asked to take part in a research study. Before you decide it is important for you to understand why the research is being done and what it will involve. Please take time to read the following information carefully. Ask us if there is anything that is not clear or if you would like more information.

This is a research study conducted by researchers at the University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign. The purpose of study is to understand how people interact with information related to alcohol use and health in their everyday lives while attempting to change their drinking behaviors. Many people seek out or encounter information when trying to make changes to their health, yet little is known about how these information interactions unfold in real time and in natural settings. This study uses brief smartphone-based surveys to capture these experiences as they occur, which may help researchers better understand the role of information in health-related behavior change.

STUDY PROCEDURE
If you choose to participate, you will complete the following study activities.

(1) Screening survey: You will complete a screening survey that asks about basic demographic information and alcohol use, among others.
(2) On-boarding meeting: If you meet the screening criteria, you will meet with a researcher over Zoom for an onboarding meeting. During this meeting, you will complete a baseline survey. The survey asks about your goals, as well as you prior knowledge of and experience with information related to alcohol and health. The survey is expected to take about 3 minutes to complete.
(3) Four-week study: If you meet the eligibility criteria, you will complete brief surveys on your smartphone each day over a period of four weeks.
    - You will receive one time-based prompt each day in the morning. This survey will ask about alcohol use during the past 24 hours and current mood and stress, and is expected to take about 2 minutes to complete.

- You will also complete event-based surveys whenever you interact with information or content that you consider relevant to your goal of changing alcohol use. These surveys will ask about what information you interacted with and how you perceived that information, and are expected to take about 4 minutes to complete.
- You will meet with a study moderator for a brief check-in at the 2-week point.

(4) Exit interview: After completing the four-week study period, you will participate in an approximately 30-minute exit interview. The interview will be audio recorded for research purposes.

RISKS

The risks associated with this study are minimal. Some questions may ask you to reflect on your health behaviors or information you have encountered, which may feel mildly uncomfortable or sensitive. You may stop participating at any time without penalty.

BENEFITS

There are no direct benefits from participating in this study. However, your participation may help researchers better understand everyday health information experiences and inform the design of future tools or interventions to support individuals seeking to change their alcohol use behavior.

HOW WILL THE RESEARCHERS PROTECT MY INFORMATION?

Data collected through surveys and interviews will be stored on secure, password-protected servers. Participant data will be de-identified immediately after collection. Any information that could directly identify participants will be stored separately from research data and will be accessible only to authorized members of the research team. Interview recordings will be used for research purposes only, and transcripts will be de-identified by removing names or other identifying information. Only the research team will have access to the data, and study results will be reported in a way that does not identify individual participants (e.g., reported in aggregates or using de-identified excerpts).

WHO WILL HAVE ACCESS TO THE INFORMATION COLLECTED DURING THIS RESEARCH STUDY?

Efforts will be made to limit the use and disclosure of your personal information, including research study records, to people who have a need to review this information. We cannot promise complete secrecy.

There are reasons why information about you may be used or seen by other people beyond the research team during or after this study. Examples include:

- University officials, government officials, study funders, auditors, and the Institutional Review Board may need access to the study information to make sure the study is done in a safe and appropriate manner.
- The research team may give information to appropriate authorities for reasons of health and safety – for example, if you indicate that you plan to harm yourself or others, or for public health reasons.

HOW MIGHT THE INFORMATION COLLECTED IN THIS STUDY BE SHARED IN THE FUTURE?

We will keep the information we collect about you during this research study for study recordkeeping. Your name and other information that can directly identify you will be stored securely and separately from the rest of the research information we collect from you.

The researchers plan to contact you within approximately one week after completion of the four-week survey period to schedule an optional interview.

De-identified data from this study may be shared with the research community, with journals in which study results are published, and with databases and data repositories used for research. We will remove or code any personal information that could directly identify you before the study data are shared. Despite these measures, we cannot guarantee the anonymity of your personal data.

PERSON TO CONTACT
If you have questions, complains or concerns about this study, you can contact Bogeum Choi at bogeumc@illinois.edu.

Institutional Review Board: If you have any questions about your rights as a research subject, including concerns, complaints, or to offer input, you may call the Office for the Protection of Research Subjects (OPRS) at 217-333-2670 or e-mail OPRS at irb@illinois.edu. If you would like to complete a brief survey to provide OPRS feedback about your experiences as a research participant, please follow the link here or through a link on the OPRS website: https://oprs.research.illinois.edu/. You will have the option to provide feedback or concerns anonymously or you may provide your name and contact information for follow-up purposes.

VOLUNTARY PARTICIPATION
Research studies include only people who choose to take part. You can tell us that you don't want to be in this study. You can start the study and then choose to stop participating later, and this will not affect your relationship with the investigators.

COSTS AND COMPENSATION TO PARTICIPANTS
There are no costs to participate in this study beyond those associated with normal smartphone use, such as data usage.

CONSENT
By entering my initial on this consent form, I confirm I have read the information in this consent form and have had the opportunity to ask questions. I will be given a copy of this consent form. I voluntarily agree to take part in this study.

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